



Niterói Contemporary Art Museum

Dramatically perched above a cliff, a clean-lined gallery designed by the master of Modernism

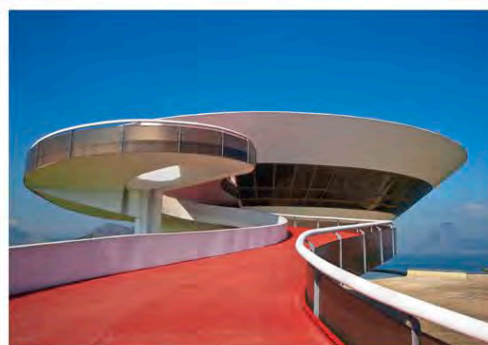


△ READY FOR TAKE-OFF

The structure of the building has often been likened to a UFO poised for take-off at the edge of the waters of Guanabara Bay. The museum's location on a rocky promontory offers breathtaking views of the city of Rio de Janeiro.

Brazilian architect Oscar Niemeyer (1907–2012) is famed for his striking Modernist architecture. The Contemporary Art Museum in Niterói, outside Rio de Janeiro, is one of his simplest buildings. Completed in 1996, the museum takes the shape of a saucer, 52 ft (16 m) high with a cupola 164 ft (50 m) wide. Inside are three floors; the main, column-free Hall of Expositions has a capacity of only 60 people, making it an exclusive venue. Access to the museum from the surrounding plaza is by a 321-ft- (98-m-) long concrete ramp. The cylindrical base is surrounded by a reflecting pool covering 8,790 square ft (817 square m).

The main impact of the museum is in its location. Set on a cliff overlooking Boa Viagem beach, the museum lies in Niterói on the eastern side of Guanabara Bay, facing Rio de Janeiro on the opposite shore.

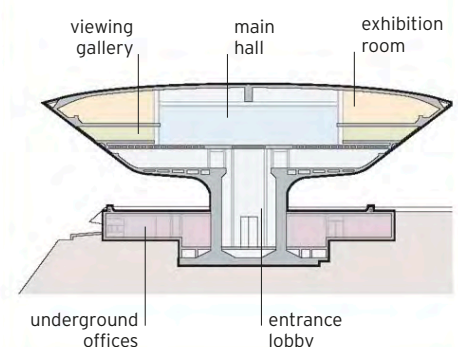


△ MAKING AN ENTRANCE

A boldly colored suspended walkway, recalling a red carpet, appears to be attached to the side of the saucer. It takes visitors to the Hall of Expositions.

SIMPLICITY OF DESIGN

A cross-section through the museum reveals the simplicity of its design. A walkway leads up to the main building, which contains offices, the main gallery, two smaller side galleries, and a viewing gallery around the edge. Offices and other rooms are buried underground.



“Niterói” comes from the local Tupi language and means **“water that hides”**